
WHAT YOU VALUE MOST

How to find a dentist you can stay with

Why continuity does more clinical work than people realise, six questions that reveal whether a practice can actually offer it, and how to tell once you are there.

The Familiar Face · A Dentist Fit guide · General information, not dental advice

Why this is a reasonable thing to want

Wanting the same dentist each time gets treated as a preference about comfort. It is really a preference about accuracy. Dentistry is one of the few kinds of care where the diagnostic method is comparison over time, and a tooth that has changed slightly since last year is obvious to the person who looked at it last year and invisible to everyone else.

Notes only carry part of this. A written record captures what was found, not the hundred small judgements about what looked normal for you. That context sits in one person's memory, and it is the reason a long relationship catches things early.

The practical upshot is that continuity is worth asking about directly rather than hoping for. It is a structural property of how a practice is staffed and booked, not something that happens by luck.

Six questions worth asking any practice

These work on any practice. Take them with you wherever you go, including somewhere that is not us.

1 How many dentists work here, and will I see the same one?

The most useful question on the list, and the one people most often forget to ask before they are already a patient.

2 Can I book with a specific dentist, or do I take whoever is available?

These are different systems. Both are legitimate. Only one of them gives you what you said you want.

3 Who reads my x-rays, and who writes my notes?

Sometimes the person who examines you is not the person who reviews the images. Worth knowing which it is.

4 What happens to my file if my dentist leaves?

Ask this even where the answer seems obvious. It tells you how the practice thinks about continuity as an idea.

5 Will I see the same hygienist as well?

You may see a hygienist more often than a dentist. Continuity there matters for the same reason and gets asked about far less.

6

How far ahead do you book, and do you hold recall appointments?

A practice that cannot fit you in for six months cannot give you continuity in practice, whatever the answer to question one was.

A quiet test. On your second visit, notice whether anyone refers to something from your first without reading it off a screen. That one moment tells you more than any answer you were given at the front desk.

Signs you are actually getting it

- Your dentist refers to your history without being prompted
- You are told who you will be seeing when you book, not when you arrive
- The same hygienist, or a short list of them, rather than a new face each time
- Someone notices a change you had not mentioned
- You can get hold of a specific person when something is wrong

WHERE WE FIT

A small practice, on purpose

Reflections is two chairs on Crowchild Trail. Dr. Ashish Mehta sees a small number of people, and that is a deliberate choice about how he wants to practise.

Two chairs sets a hard limit on how many people can be seen, which is what makes continuity arithmetic here rather than a promise. If you come to Reflections, you see Dr. Mehta.

"I see a small number of people, and that is on purpose."

Dr. Ashish Mehta

Ask us these too

This guide is only worth anything if it works on us as well. If you come in, put these to Dr. Mehta directly.

1

Will I see you every time, including for cleanings?

Ask it plainly. It is the whole reason you are considering a practice this size.

2 How many patients do you see in a day?

The answer sets a ceiling on how well anyone can know you.

3 How long have your patients been with you?

Length of relationship is the honest measure of whether continuity is real here.

Fifteen minutes, free, no treatment

Come and meet Dr. Mehta before you commit to anything. Fifteen minutes, no treatment, no examination, and no cost. It is a conversation, and it is the cheapest way to find out whether a place suits you.

Book your free 15 minutes

4600 Crowchild Trail NW, Suite 505, Calgary · (587) 327-8651
Nothing is done to your teeth at this visit, and there is no cost.

This guide is general information about choosing dental care. It is not dental advice, it is not a diagnosis, and it is not a comment on any other practice. The questions in it are worth asking of any dentist, including this one. Your own dentist knows your mouth and your history, and nothing here replaces that. Reflections Dental Group, Calgary, Alberta.